



r/ucla X

Search in r/ucla



Create



1



r/ucla • 2y ago

Economy_Candidate_60



off campus apartments

for anyone living in off campus apartments, how much do you pay for rent? what are the pros and cons for your building?

any off campus apartment recs? thanks in advance !



20



11

[Join the conversation](#)

Sort by: Best ▾

[Search Comments](#)

travelingwaterfall • 2y ago

Hi! I currently live off-campus and have experience dorms, UCLA apartments, and now off-campus non UCLA-affiliated apartments. Here are some pros and cons..

For dorms and UCLA-affiliated apartments, it's going to be cheaper compared to living on your own as you are sharing with roommates. If you are looking with roommates. Price can generally be the same or even cheaper. The dorms were nice but I needed my own space. I absolutely hated living in my 4bd4p because of my roommates, even with my own room I felt trapped so make sure you are living with people you enjoy.

I absolutely love my apartment building, but living on your own is very different compared to UCLA's apartments. I don't want to doxx myself so I won't say my exact building, but I live close to campus in Westwood.

Cons

- My unit has a bug problem, my landlord took a while to take care of it and the problem still persists. I have to spray for bugs on my own out of pocket. This is my least favorite thing and I may have not chosen this unit if I knew.
- Old/dirty. I had to majorly clean when I moved in and most of the building is super old. Some parts of my unit are updated but not every unit in the building is, so tour every unit you may sign a lease for. Clean everything, I mean everything.
- Loud/noisy neighbors, can hear them walking/talking.
- Parking. I don't need it but it is hard to get and quite expensive, but more doable than university apartments.



r/ucla X

Search in r/ucla



Create



1



ready for fall.

- Payment method. You don't just pay your BruinBill, you get a refund so you have to make sure you have direct deposit set up and you pay your rent/utilities online every month. You have to be responsible. You have to pay for utilities now, too, and it is a different price each month.
- Away from campus/other students/friends. My dorm friends never come visit me because I am far away from them, and going to the hill constantly is tiring. If all your friends are off-campus too this shouldn't be an issue, though.
- Expensive. I currently pay \$2,000 a month for a studio close to campus, but this can be offset by having roommates, a refund from school, a job, savings, etc. This does not include utilities or food. Electricity is expensive, and gas can add up too if your building doesn't pay for it.
- No housing guarantee
- Putting down a deposit + first months rent + setting up utilities is super expensive. I spent like \$5,000 in a few days.
- No super high-speed wifi that never fails.
- Few laundry machines, but that has only been a problem once or twice for me since I've moved in this year. I just wait 30 minutes and they're free though.
- Hard to find a nice apartment if you haven't started looking in Jan/Feb.
- WESTWOOD SMELLS BAD. Anywhere outside of UCLA-affiliated areas has furniture outside, homeless people, mattresses, overflowing garbage, loud frats, bottles, trash, etc.
- UCLA is testing out meal plans for some University Apartment students, if you enjoy UCLA food this could be important to you. I don't really care though lol.
- Not accessible. Old buildings = no elevators.
- Beware of scams/bad apartment buildings. Axiom comes to mind for me but I have never lived there. Toured it, hated it, read bad reviews, said nope.
- Lack of study spaces. I enjoyed the lounges and study rooms on the hill and at the apartments, but in off-campus apartments you only have your unit, campus, and Westwood. Now you gotta take your phone call outside or in the hallways if your roommate wants to sleep.
- When Westwood's power goes out, yours might too. No backup generators.

Pros

- Every decision is your own. Furnish it how you want, eat what you want because no meal plan, learn to be an adult. I love being independent and I feel a lot better in my own apartments versus a university apartment, it just feels different.
- Flexible leases, you can stay into summer if you need or move in early.
- Close to Westwood. In n out, Dunkin, Trader Joes, Ralphs, etc.
- Grocery delivery services/DoorDash/Uber Eats/Etc. can easily find your apartment/unit because they don't need a card to swipe in. I get my groceries delivered right to my door with a subscription fee I pay yearly. Super worth it. (Get through Ralphs, Vons, Walmart, etc.)
- You don't have to deal with RSU, and can likely renew your lease if you want to stay another year.
- Affordable Connectivity Program and SNAP benefits. \$25/month wifi and \$291/month in EBT.



r/ucla X

Search in r/ucla



Create



1



• Since your neighbors may be loud, YOU CAN TOO. Blast your music.

- I can have friends/partner/family over since I live on my own, couldn't do that in dorms/uni apartment if my roommates were not okay with it.
- My building is pet-friendly (with a deposit).
- 420/alc friendly. The smell is expected so you don't really have to worry about it.
- More storage. I feel like my 4b/4p had very little cupboards for everyone in the kitchen and bedrooms, but now I have a kitchen double the size and two massive closets just for myself.

Overall, I prefer living off-campus because I didn't want roommates. If you are okay with having roommates, I do think living in University Apartments is a smart decision. You will always have your housing guarantee, a nice building (most of the time), and you won't have to deal with "real life" for just a little longer. If you want to live on your own, then living off-campus will be the best decision you have ever made for yourself. It is expensive, but if you can budget your expenses, get a refund from school, get on ACP/SNAP, save money over the summer, etc., then DO IT! Living here changed my life socially and academically, no regrets. I'll drop some links below that I remember, but I would recommend walking around Westwood, calling numbers, saving websites, and scheduling tours. Trust your gut when touring, some buildings in Westwood are not quite as good as others. Not every low rent price = cheapest in Westwood if they don't cover any utilities.

rentinwestwood.com

rentwestwood.com

midvaleapts.com

jjparkapartments.com

gayleyandlindbrook.com

14

Reply



Economy_Candidate_60 OP · 2y ago

thanks so much for ur response! appreciate it so much :)

1

Reply

neriheron876 · 2y ago

I lived in 1301 Brockton Ave, a pretty nice apartment I found early this year. I pay \$1403 per month, which is pretty affordable for me. As for the pros and cons, I'd say there are more positive things than negative. The place is pretty spacious and has the basic stuff I need. It is a properly furnished shared common area shared. The only bad part is probably the distance, which takes me around 10 minutes (by car) to go to UCLA. As for recommendations, I'd suggest you check platforms like Tripalink, where you can find [UCLA off-campus housing](https://www.tripalink.com) relatively easily, filtering by your needs, price, and location.

2

Reply



r/ucla X

Search in r/ucla



Create



1



I used unishack.org to find my apartment, it's run by UCLA students and has a lot of listings

2

Reply

Born-Standard-9195 • 2y ago

Try UclaOffCampusHousing.com!

1

Reply



Intrepid_Reason8906 • 1y ago

If you go on Apartments.com, there is a map of buildings around UCLA. You can zoom in and then Google each building directly.

Also check:

Zillow -- Probably the most comprehensive because its landlords, agents, management companies

Facebook Marketplace

Realtor.com

CaliforniaApartments.com

Craigslist -- just in case there are any landlords posting on there, however there are a lot of fake listings and junk on there.

1

Reply